

1625–1635

MEN IN LACE

By the mid 1620s, with a new king, Charles I, on the English throne, the heavily padded doublets of King James I's reign (also widely worn in courts across continental Europe) were passing out of fashion. New, longer doublets in plain or subtly patterned silks replaced the tabbed styles made of the heavy woven and embroidered fabrics that were popular earlier in the 17th century. Breeches, too, changed in shape. They became much longer, reaching to mid-calf level, and were worn with soft leather boots rather than decorated shoes. Neckwear such as circular ruffs (held out behind the head by a wire support called a supportasse or a pickadil) began to fall out of fashion and give way to extravagant lace collars. The plainer fabrics of the new-style doublet were a perfect foil for such accessories, and this became a boom time for lace-makers. Lavish quantities of elaborately patterned lace were used for every accessory, from cuffs and collars to handkerchiefs and boot hose. Flemish bobbin lace was widely available, but the new fashions benefited every lace-making centre in Europe.

THE DOUBLET



Points

The padded jacket that men wore in the first part of the 17th century was known as the doublet. This garment had several variations in shape and style. The one illustrated here has deep stiffened tabs and is made of figured, paned silk. Doublets were attached to trunk hose (the short, puffed breeches that were fashionable in this period) with points or ties, which held the two parts of the outfit together. The fastenings were called "points" because of the pointed metal ends of the laces. They were often made of silver and gold thread, and added decorative trimming to the doublet.



Wide collar Deep, scallop-edged lace collars covering the shoulders were fashionable for both men and women in the mid-1630s. Often made of, or decorated with, Flemish bobbin lace, the collars were worked by hand in the finest linen threads.



1625

Dressed in black Dark clothes were a particular fashion in the Dutch United Provinces (now the Netherlands). Large ruffs made of layers of linen, expertly laundered and pressed, remained popular here long after the fashion had died out in the rest of Europe.



Bigger breeches In the mid-1630s men's breeches were becoming much fuller, with the fabric drawn in just below the knee with a series of points. The lower sleeves of a doublet were sometimes fully open to show the shirt beneath.